HACK876 × MICROSOFT

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Pour into the students, one build at a time.

Microsoft already invests in young Jamaicans who want to build with technology. Hack876 is one day where high-school students get to do exactly that.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers

WHY MICROSOFT

Microsoft already invests in young Jamaican builders through Project Blue Mountain, and a Hack876 judge works at Microsoft.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

A Gold contribution toward the prizes and the student programme.

Gold Partner: J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000. Any amount within the level is welcome.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Helps support the prizes for the top teams, and the mentoring and judging on the day.

WHAT MICROSOFT RECEIVES

Gold recognition, and a written recap of who took part and what they built.

THE NEXT STEP

A conversation about whether Microsoft would consider supporting the inaugural event, at Gold or any other level, and who would need to approve it. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com



Young Jamaicans, real skills, real builds.

Hack876 reaches students a few years before university, while they are still deciding what to study.

MICROSOFT, ABOUT

“Microsoft's mission is to empower every person and every organization on the planet to achieve more.”[2]

Microsoft piloted Project Blue Mountain in 2024 to help make Jamaica the premier hub for STEAM talent development in the Caribbean, reaching secondary and tertiary institutions.[3]

Shane Patterson on leading it: "Coming back home and being able to pour into the students the way I would've wanted for myself is priceless."[4]

Tech Wave 2025 was set to open to high-school students for the first time, alongside university teams, with more than 30 teams mentored by technical experts.[4]

WHAT MICROSOFT ALREADY BACKS IN JAMAICA

2021

A national skills agreement.

Microsoft Jamaica and the Ministry of Education sign a five-year agreement to train 155,000 Jamaicans in digital skills.[5]

2022

Microsoft Day begins.

Microsoft Day starts at the University of Technology, Jamaica.[7]

2024

Project Blue Mountain is piloted.

Launched at the third Microsoft Day. Student teams pitch solutions to sustainable-development challenges in the PBM Hackathon finale.[3]

2025

AI reaches Grades 8 to 11.

A week-long AI and entrepreneurship bootcamp at UWI Mona, run with AIM Educational Services in collaboration with Project Blue Mountain.[8]

02 OUR REQUEST

Become a Gold Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

GOLD PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Microsoft already funds student hackathon prizes in Jamaica. Contributing toward the Hack876 prizes extends that to students a few years younger.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

A detailed event budget will follow before any formal commitment is asked for.

WHAT MICROSOFT WOULD RECEIVE

- **Everything in Silver**
- **More prominent placement on the website and event signage**
- **A dedicated sponsor feature****
- **Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced***
- **A written recap after the event**

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner SUGGESTED	Platinum Partner
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

Who is running it, and what we need from you.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

Schools: 2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston. Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day. Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

Our judge Jordan Howell, who works at Microsoft, is a Campion College alumnus. Status with Hack876: confirmed.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A conversation about whether Microsoft would consider supporting the inaugural event, at Gold or any other level, and who would need to approve it. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

Contribution levels, and what each receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

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3. Canada Caribbean Institute, "NCU students showcase waste management app (October 27, 2024)." canadacaribbeaninstitute.org/2024/10/27/ncu-students-showcase-waste-management-app/

4. Jamaica Observer, "Project Blue Mountain's Tech Wave Conference set to stir talent, drive innovation (October 22, 2025)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2025/10/22/project-blue-mountains-tech-wave-conference-set-stir-talent-drive-innovation/

5. Microsoft News Center, "MoEYI and Microsoft Jamaica target 155,000 persons for employability in new skills training agreement (July 30, 2021)." news.microsoft.com/es-xl/moeyi-and-microsoft-jamaica-target-155000-persons-for-employability-in-new-skills-training-agreement/

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7. Jamaica Gleaner, "UTech to host Microsoft Day 2024 (October 1, 2024)." past.jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20241001/utech-host-microsoft-day-2024

8. Jamaica Observer, "AIM Educational Services and Microsoft empower youth with AI bootcamp (July 24, 2025)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2025/07/24/aim-educational-services-microsoft-empower-youth-ai-bootcamp/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Shane Patterson, Principal Technical Program Manager, Microsoft, and Executive Director, Project Blue Mountain, with Yamile Bustamante, Country Representative, Microsoft Jamaica.